

## » SPORTSTAR ACES AWARDS

The annual Sportstar Aces Awards is back to honour a number of incredible performances across the spectrum of sports. Here are the Popular Choice categories. The voting lines are open till January 31. Visit <https://sportstar.thehindu.com/aces-awards/popular-awards/>



SCAN TO VOTE



# SPORTSTAR OF THE YEAR (MALE)

## Neeraj Chopra

Age: 25



### **Discipline: Javelin throw**

Neeraj Chopra, world No. 1 in men's javelin throw, began the year by winning Diamond League events in Doha [88.67m] and

Lausanne [87.66], before becoming the first Indian to win a gold medal at the World Athletics Championships with an 88.17m throw. He then defended his Asian Games gold with a season-best throw of 88.88m in Hangzhou. He was also one of the five finalists for the Men's World Athlete of the Year Award in 2023. HINDUSTAN TIMES

VIA GETTY IMAGES

## Virat Kohli

Age: 35



### **Discipline: Cricket**

Virat Kohli had a dream World Cup outing with an all-time-high tournament aggregate of 765 runs, including nine 50-plus scores in 11 innings and

three hundreds. During the course of the World Cup, he also notched up a record 50th ODI ton, the most by any player in this format, going past Sachin Tendulkar's tally of 49. Earlier, during the ODI Asia Cup in Sri Lanka, his unbeaten 233-run partnership with K. L. Rahul for the third wicket was the highest for any wicket in the tournament's history. In March, Kohli also hit his first Test century since 2019 on day four of the last Border-Gavaskar Trophy Test match in Ahmedabad. ICC VIA GETTY IMAGES

## Satwiksairaj

## Rankireddy-Chirag Shetty

Age: 23



### **Discipline: Badminton**

Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty won India's first ever badminton gold medal at the Asian Games in Hangzhou. Earlier

in the year, the two became the first Indian doubles pair to win a gold medal at the Badminton Asia Championship, the country's first gold medal at the tournament in close to six decades. The duo also won its first title in the 2023 Swiss Open, beating the Chinese pair of Ren Xiangyu and Tan Qiang in the final. India's rising profile in badminton was reaffirmed when Satwik and Chirag rose to number 1 in the BWF Men's Doubles Rankings in October. GETTY IMAGES

## R. Praggnanandhaa

Age: 18



### **Discipline: Chess**

At the age of 18, R. Praggnanandhaa became the youngest Chess World Cup finalist ever to date. He lost to Magnus Carlsen in the final. The teenager will now play in the Candidates tournament in 2024. He is the third youngest player after Bobby Fischer and Carlsen to qualify for the Candidates tournament. The youngster had also won the Asian

Games team silver and registered a peak rating of 2740-plus. He added yet another feather to his cap by defeating 2800-rated Grandmaster Ding Liren for the first time in a classical game at the Tata Steel Chess Masters. AFP

VIA GETTY IMAGES

## Sumit Antil

Age: 25



### **Discipline: Javelin throw (Men's F64)**

Sumit Antil is the world record holder in men's javelin (F64). In October, the reigning Paralympics champion, Antil, clinched the gold medal at the Hangzhou Asian Para Games javelin throw F64 event with a world record effort of 73.29m. The 25-year-old broke his own previous world record of 70.83m, which he had achieved, while

winning gold at the World Para Athletics Championships in Paris earlier this year. AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES